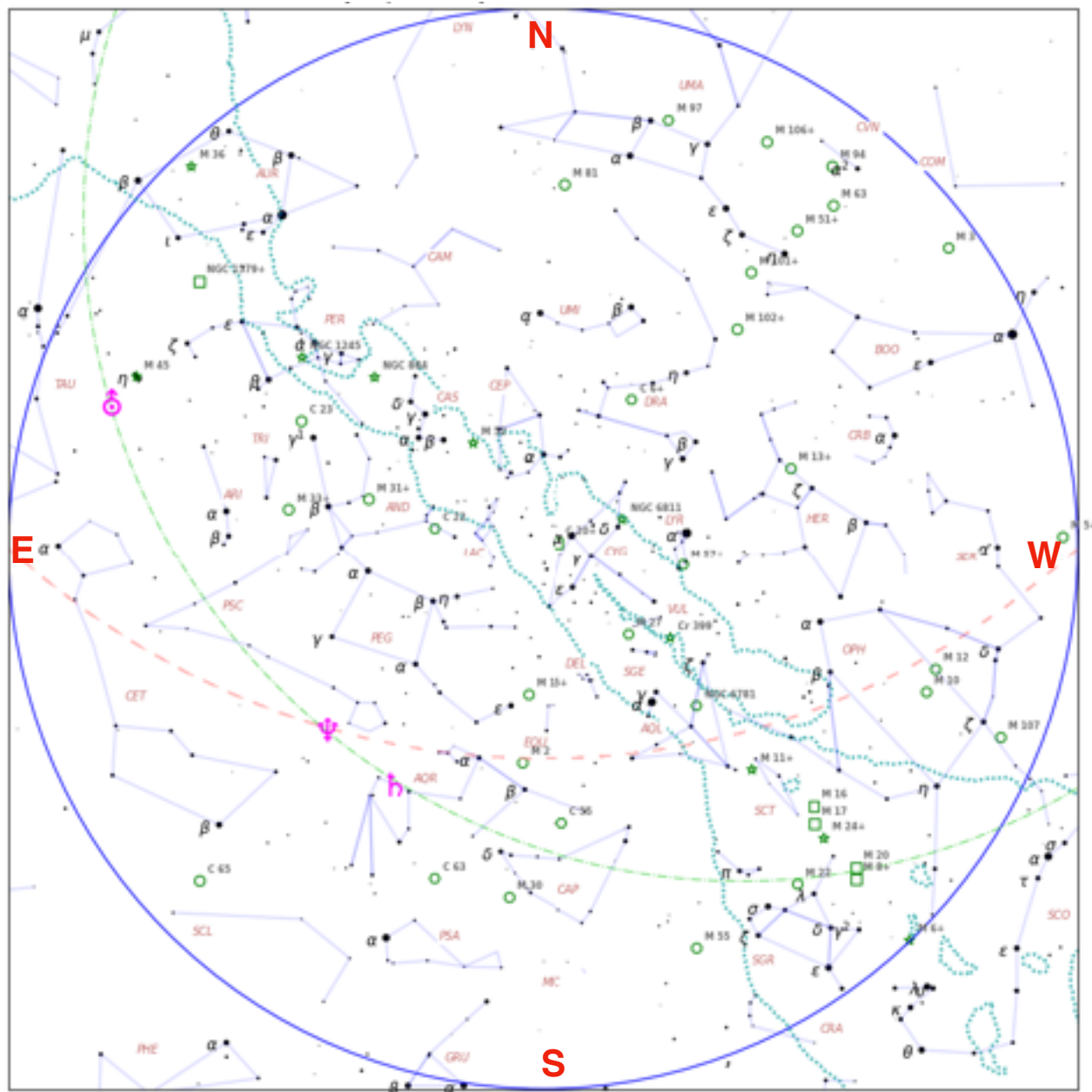


OCTOBER 2024



The Northern Berkshire Astronomical Society

Meets the first Wednesday of every month, at the
North Adams Public Library at 6 PM.

74 Church St. North Adams MA

Early Autumn Skies

With earlier dark times, and before it gets too cold, it's the last chance to catch the higher-up Milky Way constellations and return to those of the Fall. This time of year has a wide range of deep-sky object types!

Constellations

AND - Andromeda - *the Chained Maiden*
 AQL - Aquila - *the Eagle*
 AQR - Aquarius - *the Water Bearer*
 ARI - Aries - *the Ram*
 AUR - Auriga - *the Charioteer*
 BOO - Boötes - *the Herdsman*
 CAM - Camelopardalis - *the Giraffe*
 CAP - Capricornus - *the Goat*
 CAS - Cassiopeia - *the Queen of Ethiopia*
 CEP - Cepheus - *the King of Ethiopia*
 CET - Cetus - *the Whale*
 COM - Coma Berenices - *Berenice's Hair*
 CRA - Corona Australis - *the Southern Crown*
 CRB - Corona Borealis - *the Northern Crown*
 CVN - Canes Venatici - *the Hunting Dogs*
 CYG - Cygnus - *the Swan*
 DEL - Delphinus - *the Dolphin*
 DRA - Draco - *the Dragon*
 EQU - Equuleus - *the Little Horse*
 GRU - Grus - *the Crane*
 HER - Hercules - *Hercules*
 LAC - Lacerta - *the Lizard*
 LEO - Leo - *the Lion*
 LYN - Lynx - *the Lynx*
 LYR - *the Harp*
 MIC - Microscopium - *the Microscope*
 OPH - Ophiuchus - *the Serpent Bearer*
 PEG - Pegasus - *the Winged Horse*
 PER - Perseus - *the Hero*
 PHE - Phoenix - *the Phoenix*
 PSA - Piscis Austrinus - *the Southern Fish*
 PSC - Pisces - *the Fish*
 SCO - Scorpius - *the Scorpion*
 SCT - Scutum - *the Shield*
 SER - Serpens - *the Serpent*
 SGE - Sagitta - *the Arrow*
 SGR - Sagittarius - *the Archer*
 TAU - Taurus - *the Bull*
 TRI - Triangulum - *the Triangle*
 UMA - Ursa Major - *the Great Bear*
 UMI - Ursa Minor - *the Lesser Bear*
 VUL - Vulpecula - *the Little Fox*

How to Use the Chart

South is at the bottom, if you hold the chart “up” against the sky, facing South, then East will be to your left and West to the right. (Or if you hold the map upside-down and face North, East will be to the right, West to the left.)

On the chart, the orange dashed line shows the celestial Equator; the green dashed-dotted line the Ecliptic. The Milky Way is outlined with a blue dotted line.

Date	Time
Oct 1	9:30 PM (EDT)
Oct 8	9:00 PM
Oct 15	8:30 PM
Oct 22	8:00 PM
Oct 29	7:30 PM

Because of the Earth's motion around the Sun, the time for this chart changes slowly over time, roughly 1/2 hour earlier every week:

Planets

Saturn is easy to find in the SSE sky below the Great Square of Pegasus and the bright star Fomalhaut hugging the southern horizon.

Jupiter is back - rising later in the evening (just after 9PM mid-month, add or subtract 30m each week before/after mid-October. We're still chasing **Mars** in its orbit: it has moved into Gemini, but will be above the horizon around midnight.

Uranus and **Neptune** are findable in binoculars (and a finder chart) in Taurus (near the Pleiades) and Pisces, respectively. Finally **Venus** sets soon after the Sun, but will slowly start to hang around later rising higher through the end of 2024.